



TUNDRA



Tundra is the region around the southern edges of the Arctic Circle. It is covered with snow for much of the year, which melts during the spring and summer allowing small plants to grow. Animals that live here have a thick layer of fur or feathers and can store fat to keep them warm through the winter.

BOREAL FOREST



Boreal forest, or taiga, contains the world's tallest, toughest trees. Conifers thrive here because their needle-like leaves are strong and windproof, and allow snow to slide off. The top animals here are predatory mammals such as wolves, foxes, weasels, and wolverines.



DESERTS



Deserts are hot and extremely dry. Plants such as cacti have swollen stems or roots that can store water, and tiny leaves to prevent water loss. Desert animals can go for long periods without water, and some build burrows to escape the daytime heat.

GRASSLANDS



Natural grasslands are found on all continents—they get very hot in summer but don't have enough rainfall to support many trees or shrubs. Instead they are covered in grasses and plants that make ideal grazing for herds of plant-eating mammals. These, in turn, provide a meal for large carnivores such as lions.

POLAR



Ice, hurricane winds, freezing temperatures, and months of endless darkness make polar regions inhospitable to most land-dwelling species—those that live here migrate with the seasons. Yet the polar oceans are teeming with life, from microscopic plankton to the huge blue whale.

My thick fur keeps me warm in the North Pole

